

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

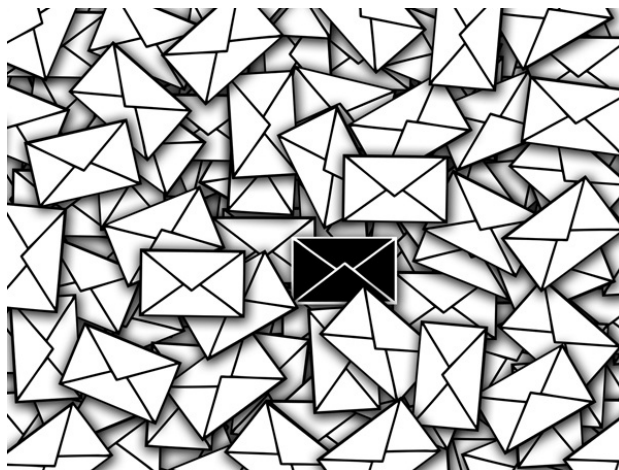
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Vanessa has a lot of explaining to do!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a customer complaint.
- I can write warnings and threats using *if*.
- I can write about purpose and intention.

Ask your partner:

- Have you experienced poor customer service in a restaurant? What happened?
- What is the worst meal you've ever had?





Let's Explore!

Michael Roth is furious! Not only did he have a disastrous experience, his **personal judgement*** has been questioned.

* "Personal judgement" means the decisions a person makes.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

General Manager
Bistro 88
348 Welling St.
Cambridge, Massachusetts
October 25th

Dear Ms Wright,

I was a customer who recommended your restaurant to clients during their recent stay in Boston.

Unfortunately, the sub-standard food quality and incompetent service we experienced reflected poorly not only on my own personal judgement but also on Cambridge's ability to deliver a world-class dining experience.

Our table should have realized the incompetence of your kitchen staff the minute they received their appetizers, or should I say, some of their appetizers. For those who received their meals on time, the tuna tartare was tasteless and pale in color. The rest of the group were told that the restaurant had sold out of fresh mussels. They resigned themselves to overpriced caesar salads.

The main course tasted equally bad. There was one overriding factor. They were all stone cold and undercooked! When I expressed my concerns to an idle waitress, she appeared bewildered and confused. Finally, I told her that if we eat these meals, we will get sick and sue the restaurant. With that, she turned and marched towards the kitchen in tears.

Shortly after, we spotted the same waitress removing her socks and shoes in the dining room. That was the last straw. In the end, we placed cash on the table for the appetizers and drinks. We were not prepared to put up with such a circus any longer.

After this experience, I have no intention of ever setting foot in your establishment again. I am eager to speak with you directly about this experience.

If I don't receive a response within three days, I will contact the food safety authority.

Offering raw chicken and pork to customers is completely unacceptable.

Furthermore, I intend to post my grievances online if I don't hear from you. Believe me, I'm eager to express my views to the public. If there isn't a food related incident at your restaurant in the next month, I will be surprised.

What incompetence!

Sincerely,

Michael Roth





Let's Practice!

What are Mr. Roth's plans if his letter is not taken seriously?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct words above the wrong ones.

1. After this experience, I have no extension of ever setting foot in your establishment again.
2. I am eagered to speak with you directly about this experience.
3. Furthermore, I intending to post my grievances online if I don't hear from you.
4. Believe me, I'm eagere to express my views to the public.
5. I'm tempting to call the authorities right now!



Let's Practice!

Mr. Roth makes a number of threats and warnings.

Instructions: Choose the option that best completes the sentences.

1

if we eats
if we eating
if we eat

will be
will
be

2

If I doesn't receive
If I don't receive
If I doesn't received

contacting
contacts
contact

3

If there doesn't
If there isn't
If there being

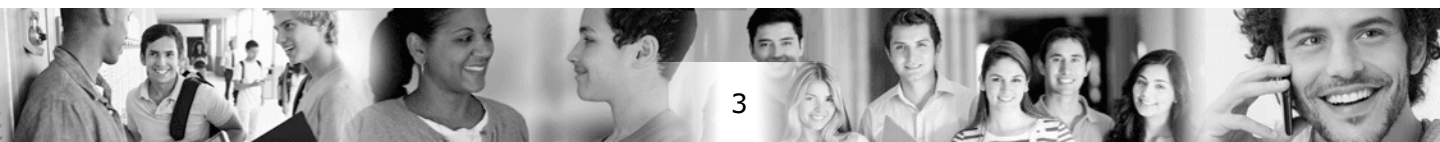
is
be
am

4

If you don't change
If you don't changes
If you changes

was
will
is

1. Finally, I told her that _____ these meals, we _____ get sick and sue the restaurant.
2. _____ a response within three days, I will _____ the food safety authority.
3. _____ a food related incident at your restaurant in the next month, I will _____ surprised.
4. _____ your business practices, you _____ be out of business in a year.





Extension Activity

You have just returned from a shopping trip and you are furious!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 150-170 word letter of complaint to a business in your community.
- Include the business' address.
- Start with a formal greeting and end with a formal closing.
- State the reason for the letter at the beginning of the letter.
- Explain what happened in detail and how it affected your experience.
- Describe your plans and intentions in the future.
- When completed, read your letter of complaint aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write a letter of complaint to a business.

☐ ☐

I explain what happened in detail.

☐ ☐

I describe my plans and future intentions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- stone cold** (expression): totally or completely
e.g. They were all stone cold and undercooked!
- idle** (adjective): not working, active, or being used
e.g. I expressed my concerns to an idle waitress.
- bewildered** (adjective): confused
e.g. She appeared bewildered when she learned the news.
- last straw** (expression): the last in the series of annoyances or disappointments that someone is willing to accept
e.g. That was the last straw.
- to resign oneself** (verb): to make yourself accept something that is bad or that cannot be changed
e.g. They resigned themselves to overpriced caesar salads.





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Using the First Conditional to Write About Warnings and Threats

You use the First Conditional with *if* clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.

The First Conditional with an *if* clause is also used to convey a warning or a threat in a formal letter.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will or will not do something. In that condition, something else may, may not, will, or will not happen.

You use the First Conditional to focus on a warning or a threat, especially in the case of a customer complaint or a warning letter.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

Structure:

If + Present Simple ... will + verb ...

Read the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Finally, I told her that if we eat these meals, we will get sick and sue the restaurant.*
- *If I don't receive a response within three days, I will contact the food safety authority.*
- *If there isn't a food related incident at your restaurant in the next month, I will be surprised.*
- *If you don't change your business practices, you will be out of business in a year.*





Learning Points

Using Verbs, Nouns and Adjectives to Express Purpose

Besides using linking clauses to express your purpose, you can use certain verbs, nouns or adjectives to achieve the same effect.

When you want to express purpose and intention, the following words and expressions can be used.

- Verbs

I mean/plan/intend/aim/hope to ...

- Nouns

My goal/intention/dream/purpose/hope/aim is to ...

- Adjectives

I'm eager/determined/resolved/tempted to ...

Read the following examples from the text, and notice how a letter of complaint needs to have a strong sense of purpose and intention to carry its message:

Examples:

- *After this experience, I have no intention of ever setting foot in your establishment again.*
- *I am eager to speak with you directly about this experience.*
- *Furthermore, I intend to post my grievances online if I don't hear from you.*
- *Believe me, I'm eager to express my views to the public.*
- *I'm tempted to call the authorities right now!*

